

Using the Passive Voice



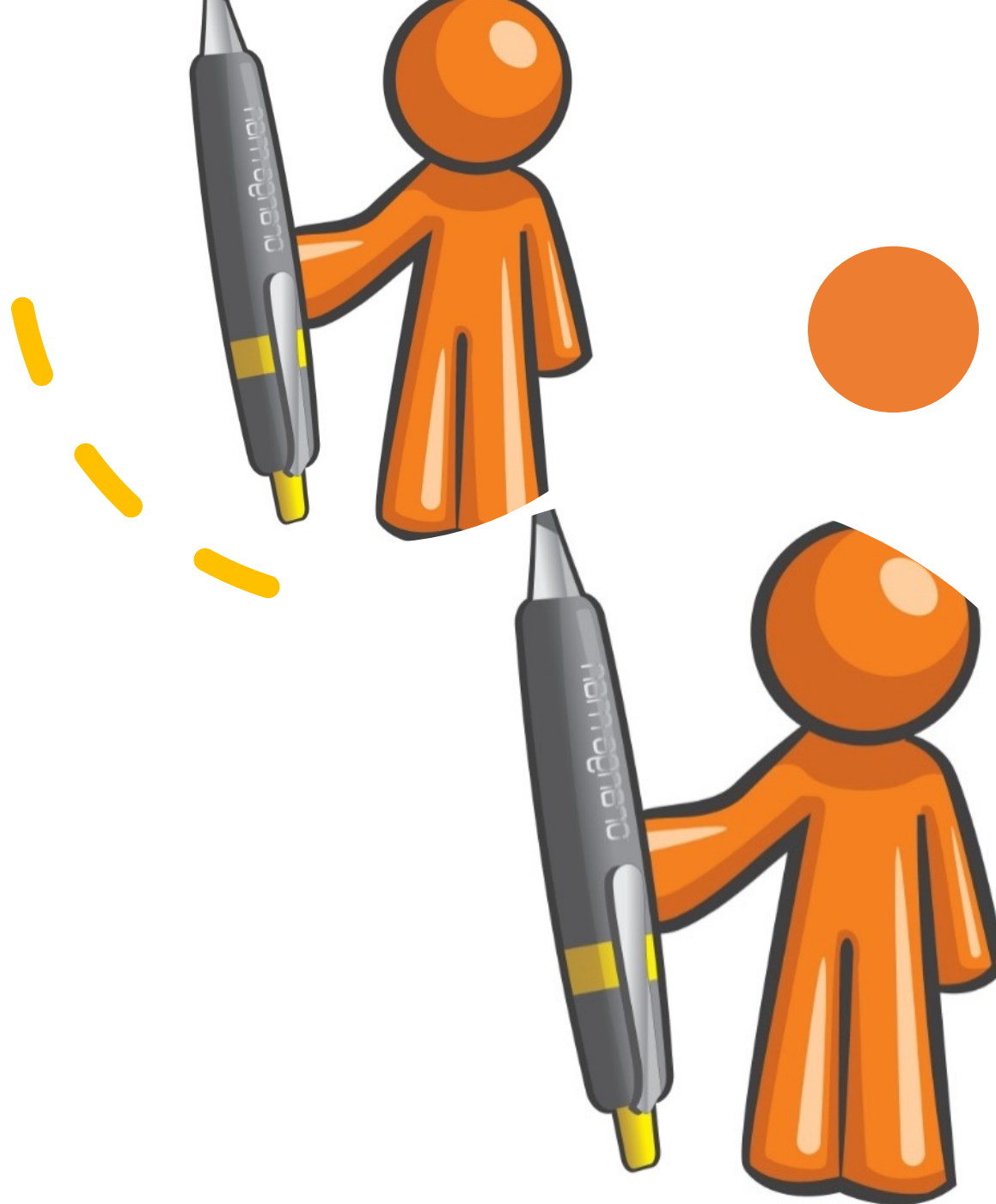
Active Voice vs. Passive Voice

Active voice takes the form
“A does B”

- We chose the plastic film to cover the microphone

Passive voice takes the form
“B is done (by A)”

- Plastic film was chosen (by us) to cover the microphone



Omit the
“Agent” of
the Action

Active

- ***Workers installed burglar alarms.***

Passive, with agent

- ***Burglar alarms were installed by the workers.***

Passive, with the agent omitted

- ***Burglar alarms were installed.***

“To be” + Past Participle



“To be” is very irregular:

	Present Tense		Past Tense		+ Part. Pasado
1 st person	I am	We are	I was	We were	read - studied
2 nd person	You are	You are	You were	You were	written - run
3 rd person	He, she, it is	They are	He, she, it was	They were	programmed

- Past participles usually add “-ed” or “-t”: presented, measured, built, burnt.
- Irregular past principles must be memorized.

Form: How do we make the passive?



subject	auxiliary verb to be	past participle
Tim's house	was	broken into.
No one	has been	arrested.
The door	hadn't been	locked.
She	will be	operated on.
They	were	trained.
It	is	opened.

by a friend.

Notice how the verb *to be* changes depending on the tense.

The main verb is always in the past participle.

In the passive voice, the subject is not the agent (i.e. the person/thing doing the action). In order to mention the agent we can add **by...** after the past participle.

Subject

Auxiliary verb **to be**

Past participle

future simple

past perfect

past simple

present perfect

present simple
(is- are – am)

Modal+ “To be” + Past Participle

Tambien podemos usar los verbos modales en pasiva:

MODAL + BE + PAST PARTICIPLE

Ejemplos

- **may be filmed** (puede ser filmado);
- **may not be filmed** (puede no ser filmado);
- **have to be used** (tiene que ser utilizados);
- **haven't to be used** (no tienen que ser utilizados), etc.



Formas de traducción de la Voz Pasiva

a. Cuando la estructura de voz pasiva va seguido de “by” mas quién o que realiza la acción la traducción es literal, por ejemplo:

✓ Microsoft was found by Bill Gates.

.....

✓ The first digital computer was built by the university of Pennsylvania in 1946.

.....

b. Cuando en la oración pasiva no aparece el completo agente (by) es conveniente realizar una traducción impersonal, o sea:

SE + VERBO CONJUGADO

✓ Different alternatives can be considered.

.....



Formas de traducción de la Voz Pasiva

c. Cuando la voz pasiva va seguida de un infinitivo la traducción será

VOZ PASIVA IMPERSONAL + QUE + (SUSTANTIVO) + VERBO CONJUGADO

✓ It is assumed to be symbolic.

A su vez el infinitivo puede ser activo o pasivo, por ejemplo:

✓ You are supposed to know the answer.

✓ The reaction it's said to be accelerated.

RECUERDA: Esta traducción de la voz pasiva con infinitivo es valida solamente con los verbos llamados “de opinión” (say, suppose, think, assume, consider, believe, etc,), compara con el siguiente caso en el que aparece una estructura similar pero con otro tipo de verbo:

It is used to produce energy.



VOZ PASIVA PARA PROCESOS ► PASSIVE FOR PROCESS

A la **voz pasiva** la utilizamos para describir **cómo se hacen, se usan o se fabrican** las cosas en determinados procesos o procedimientos.



VOZ PASIVA PARA PROCESOS ► PASSIVE FOR PROCESS

- Las estructuras pasivas se utilizan con tres motivos diferentes.

1.	DESCRIBIR COMO SE LLEVA A CABO ALGO
	Each part in a movie script is memorized. Cada papel de una película es memorizado (se memoriza).
	• All of the costumes have to be designed.

VOZ PASIVA PARA PROCESOS ► PASSIVE FOR PROCESS

2.

DESCRIBIR COMO SE UTILIZA ALGO

Microphones are held above the actors.

Los micrófonos son colgados (se cuelgan) por encima de los actores.

- The best sound equipment has to be used.

VOZ PASIVA PARA PROCESOS ► PASSIVE FOR PROCESS

3. DESCRIBIR COMO SE FABRICA ALGO

Some movies are filmed "on location."

Algunas películas son filmadas (se filman) en exteriores.

- Thousands of scenes have to be shot.

VOZ PASIVA PARA ACONTECIMIENTOS ► PASSIVE FOR EVENTS

A la **voz pasiva** también la utilizamos para describir **eventos o acontecimientos**. Se relacionan con hechos del pasado.



VOZ PASIVA PARA ACONTECIMIENTOS ► EVENTS

- Las estructuras pasivas se utilizan en pasado.

	DESCRIBIR UN ACONTECIMIENTO
	• Cobol was first introduced in 1959. Cobol se presentó por primera vez en 1959.
	• Microsoft was founded on the basis of the development of MS/DOS.

EXERCISE

- **Lea el texto. Subraya los verbos en voz pasiva. Tradúzcalos.**
- **What is C programming?**

C is a general-purpose programming language that is extremely popular, simple and flexible. It is machine-independent, structured programming language which is used extensively in various applications.

C was the basic language to write everything from operating systems (Windows and many others) to complex programs like the Oracle database, Git, Python interpreter and more.

It is said that 'C' is a god's programming language. One can say, C is a base for the programming. If you know 'C,' you can easily grasp the knowledge of the other programming languages that uses the concept of 'C'

It **is** essential to have a background in computer memory mechanisms because it is an important aspect when dealing with the C programming language.

